

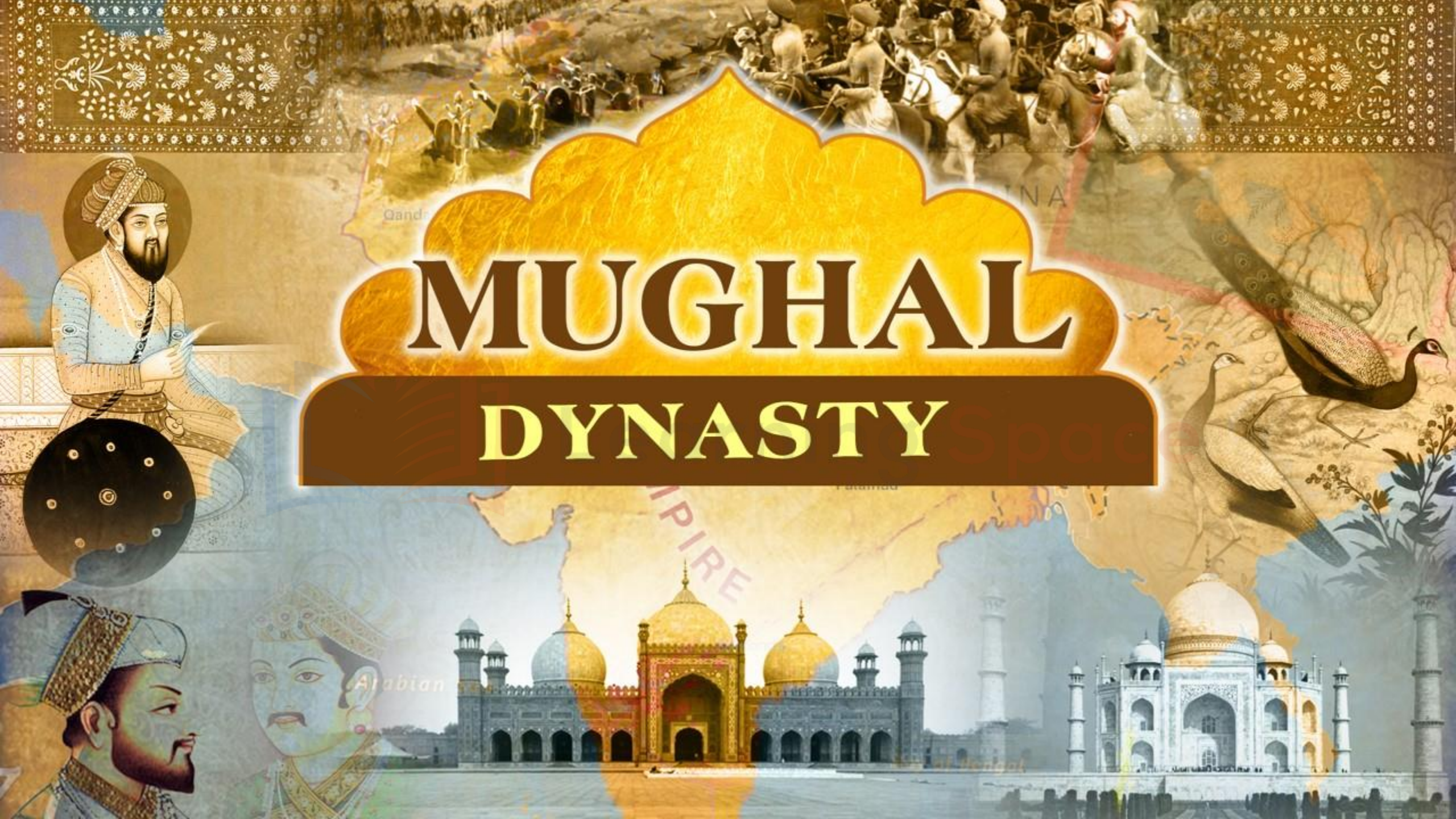
MEDIEVAL HISTORY



MODULE - 21

MUGHAL DYNASTY
HUMAYUN





MUGHAL DYNASTY

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HUMAYUN (1530–1556 AD)



- 1 ■ Humayun (Nasir ud-din Muhammad Khan Humayun) was born to Mahim Begam and Babur and was the eldest son of Babur.
■ 'Humayun' means 'fortune', but he remained the most unfortunate ruler of the Mughal Empire.
- 2 He succeeded Babur at the young age of 23 and had to cope up with number of problems left behind by Babur.

MUGHAL DYNASTY

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HUMAYUN (1530–1556 AD)



3 The main problems faced by Humayun were:

- 1) The newly conquered territories and administration was not consolidated, and the finances were precarious.
- 2) Unlike Babur, Humayun did not command the respect and esteem of Mughal nobility. The Chaghatai nobles were not favourably inclined towards him and the Indian nobles, who had joined Babur's service, deserted the Mughals at Humayun's accession.
- 3) He also had to confront the hostility of the Afghans and other prominent provincial rulers as they were not fully subdued.
This included :
 - ✓ Sher Khan, a powerful Afghan of Bihar
 - ✓ Bahadur Shah, the provincial ruler of Gujarat.
- 4) As per the Timurid tradition, Humayun had to share power with his brothers which created multiple centres of power:
 - ✓ Kamran – Kabul, Qandahar and Punjab
 - ✓ Hindal – Alwar and
 - ✓ Mewat Mirza Aksari – Sambhal

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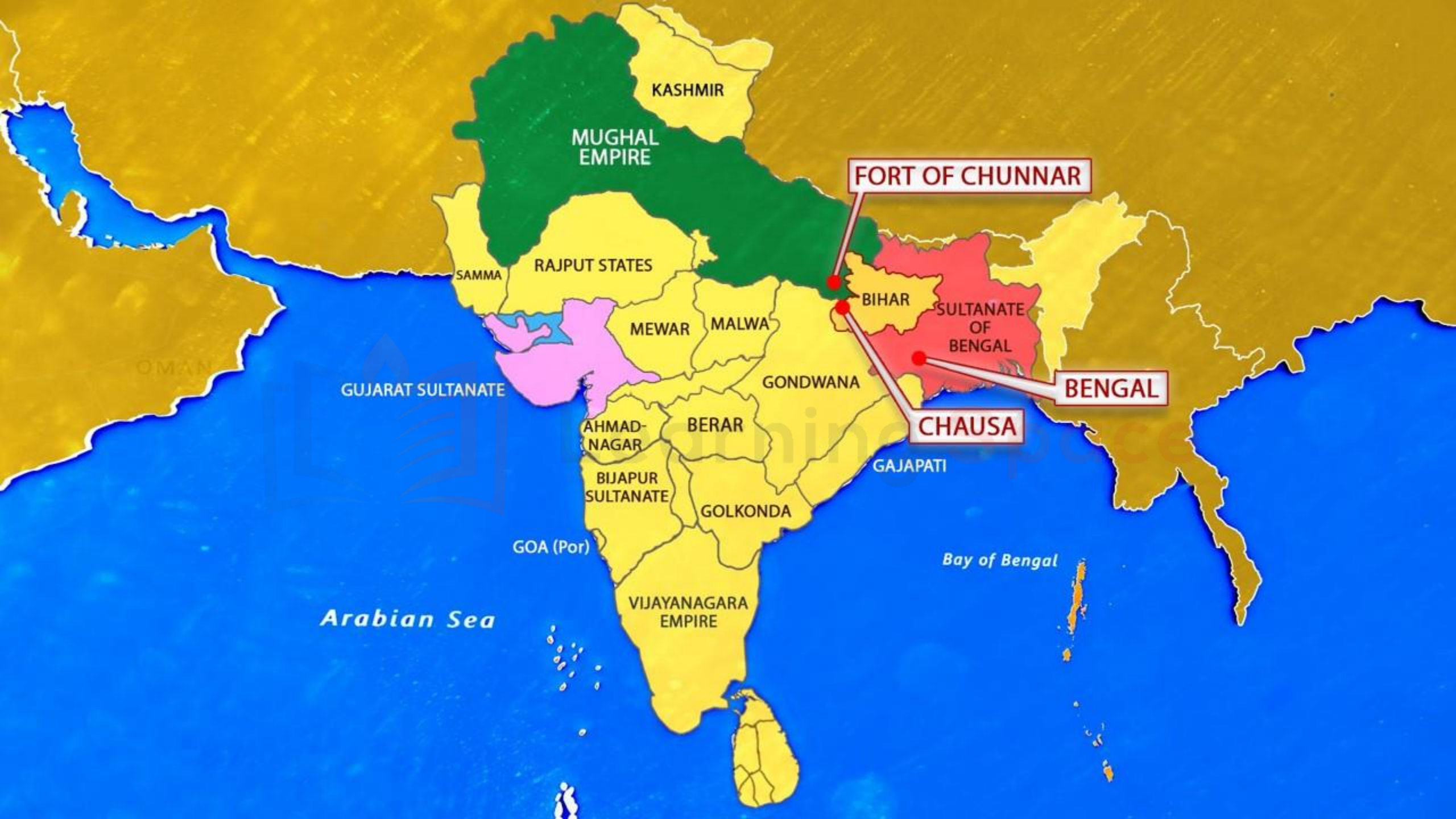
HUMAYUN (1530–1556 AD)



1 In 1532 AD at Daurah, he defeated the Afghan forces which had conquered Bihar and Jaunpur.

2 Then, he besieged the powerful fort of Chunar from the Afghan sardar Sher Khan, which commanded the land and the river route between Agra and the east and was thus known as the gateway of eastern India. But in spite of the position of superiority, he made a treaty with rising Afghan leader Sher Khan, leaving him in full control of area east of Banaras and also the possession of the fort in lieu of his loyalty, (a mistake which cost him his empire later).

3 A probable reason for this hastiness was the advance of Bahadur Shah of Gujarat towards the Mughal frontiers, specially towards Malwa and Rajputana. In such a situation, Humayun was forced to rush back to Agra (1532–33 AD).



MUGHAL
EMPIRE

KASHMIR

FORT OF CHUNNAR

RAJPUT STATES

SAMMA

BIHAR

SULTANATE
OF
BENGAL

BENGAL

CHAUSA

GAJAPATI

MEWAR

MALWA

GONDWANA

BERAR

GOLKONDA

VIJAYANAGARA
EMPIRE

AHMAD-
NAGAR

BIJAPUR
SULTANATE

GOA (Por)

GUJARAT SULTANATE

Arabian Sea

Bay of Bengal

MUGHAL DYNASTY

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HUMAYUN (1530–1556 AD)

GUJRAT CAMPAIGN OF HUMAYUN



- 1**
 - Marching towards Malwa, Humayun seized Mandu and then stormed Champaner and Ahmedabad.
 - He appointed his younger brother Askari as viceroy of Gujarat and returned to Mandu.
- 2** The only advantage from the Gujarat campaign was that it destroyed forever the threat posed to the Mughals by Bahadur Shah and Humayun could concentrate all his resources against Sher Khan and the Afghans.
- 3**
 - It must be noted that Askari lacked experience and wasn't able to competently administer the region and the control of Mughals on it was very weak.



KASHMIR

LAHORE

MUGHAL
EMPIRE

AGRA

KANNAUJ

RAJPUT STATES

SAMMA

CHAMPANER

AHMEDABAD

GUJARAT SULTANATE

MEWAR

MALWA

SULTANATE
OF
BENGAL

GONDWANA

MANDU

AHMAD-
NAGAR

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HUMAYUN (1530–1556 AD)

COUNTERING SHER KHAN



- 4**
- During this time Sher Khan had become the unquestioned master of Bihar.
 - After equipping a new army, Humayun marched against Sher Khan and despite the best efforts by the master gunner, Rumi Khan, it took Humayun 6 months to besiege Chunar.

- 5**
- In this time Sher Khan captured the powerful fort of Rohtas by treachery, where he left his family safely and invaded Bengal and captured Gaur, its capital.
 - He then made an offer to Humayun that he would surrender Bihar and pay an annual tribute of 10 lakh dinars if he was allowed to retain Bengal.

- 6**
- But Humayun declined the offer as he did not want to lose Bengal, which was not only rich but was also a significant foreign trade centre.

MUGHAL DYNASTY

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HUMAYUN (1530–1556 AD)

BATTLE OF CHAUSA (1539 AD)



- 1 Chausa (near Buxar)
- 2 Humayun was defeated and Sher Khan and adopted the title of Sher Shah.
- 3 Humayun barely escaped with his life from the battlefield.



MUGHAL DYNASTY

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HUMAYUN (1530-1556 AD)

BATTLE OF BILGRAMA/BATTLE OF KANNAUJ (1540 AD)

- 1 After the defeat at Chausa, only the fullest unity among the Timurid princes and the nobles could have saved the Mughals.
- 2 Humayun reached Agra to negotiate with his brothers. But they were not cooperative, and Humayun could not get support of Kamran who moved out of Agra towards Lahore, leaving Humayun with small force.
- 3 -He thus was not able to prepare properly against Sher Khan. The battle of Kannauj was bitterly contested.
- Both the younger brothers of Humayun, Askari and Hindal, fought valiantly, but Humayun was still thoroughly defeated by Sher Shah.
- This battle decided the issue between Sher Shah and the Mughals.
- 4 Humayun now became a prince without a kingdom and he had to flee from Delhi, becoming an exile for the next fifteen years (1540-1555 AD).

MUGHAL DYNASTY

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HUMAYUN (1530–1556 AD)

YEARS OF EXILE OF HUMAYUN



- 1 He wandered about in Sindh (1540 AD) and its neighbouring regions for next two and half years, trying different schemes to regain his kingdom.
- 2 He married Hamida Banu Begum (daughter of Hindal's teacher) on his way to Sind.
- 3 Akbar was born in 1542 AD.
- 4 Ultimately, Humayun sought shelter at the court of the Iranian king who forced him to convert to Shia faith (Mughals were otherwise Sunni), and recaptured Gandhar and Kabul with his help in 1545 AD.

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HUMAYUN (1530–1556 AD)

YEARS OF EXILE OF HUMAYUN



- 5 In 1555 AD, following the break-up of the Sur empire, Humayun defeated the Afghans and recovered the Mughal throne.
- 6 But before he could consolidate his position, only after six months, he died from a fall from the staircase of his library at Sher Mandal at Delhi in 1556 AD.
- 7 For him, it is said that “he jumbled throughout life and was tumbled out of life”.
- 8 Humayun’s tomb is called the prototype of the Taj Mahal, and was built by his widow Haji Begum.

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